

D631

Designing Curriculum and Instruction II

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A seventh-grade teacher in a school with a new cafeteria demonstrates how to write a thesis statement, then immediately assigns students to write three on their own. Most struggle. Her class uses color-coded folders. Which step did she skip?

- A. A new folder system.
- B. Guided practice, where students try with her support before working alone.
- C. Independent practice, which should come first.
- D. More modeling; she should demonstrate ten more examples.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students are now writing thesis statements with a partner while the teacher circulates and prompts. Which step should come next?

- A. A summative test on day one.
- B. Repeat partner work until every student is perfect.
- C. Teacher modeling.
- D. Independent practice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A science teacher in a school with a rooftop garden plans a 5E lesson on density. She begins with a video of a floating egg, then gives a lecture defining density, then has students test objects in water. The lesson lasts 55 minutes. What is out of order?

- A. The video should come after the lecture.
- B. The lesson should be longer than 55 minutes.
- C. Students should test objects (Explore) before the formal definition (Explain).
- D. Nothing; teachers should always define terms first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After students explain density, the teacher asks them to predict whether a new object will float in salt water. Which 5E phase is this?

- A.** Elaborate.
- B.** Engage.
- C.** Explore.
- D.** Explain.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A teacher in a district that just adopted a new bell schedule begins a lesson by asking students what they remember about fractions from last week before introducing adding unlike fractions. The classroom has a large window facing the playground. Which instructional event is this?

- A.** Enhancing retention and transfer.
- B.** Stimulating recall of prior learning.
- C.** Assessing performance.
- D.** Gaining attention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lesson plan includes stating objectives, presenting content, and a final quiz, but no practice between them. Which event is missing?

- A.** Informing learners of the objective.
- B.** Eliciting performance with feedback.
- C.** Presenting the content.
- D.** Nothing; presenting content and testing is a complete lesson.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fifth-grade team in a school with a large gym plans a unit on local water quality. Teachers will lecture for three weeks, then students will make a poster in the final two days. The team calls it project-based learning. The school's mascot is a heron. What would make it true PBL?

- A. Replace the poster with a test.
- B. Have students design a heron-themed poster.
- C. Make the poster larger and spend three days on it.
- D. Launch with a driving question students investigate throughout, ending in a product shared with a real audience.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A teacher is an expert with video-editing software and has 300 followers on a teaching social media account. She has students make videos in chemistry, but the videos repeat textbook definitions and include errors about bonding. Which TPACK area needs growth?

- A. Content and pedagogical knowledge, so the tech serves accurate, meaningful chemistry learning.
- B. None; strong tech skills guarantee effective integration.
- C. Technology knowledge; she needs better software.
- D. Social media reach.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

The objective for a tenth-grade unit is “evaluate the reliability of historical sources.” A teacher in a district with a one-to-one laptop program assigns an online matching quiz of historians’ names to dates. The quiz auto-grades in seconds. What is the main design problem?

- A. The quiz should be on paper instead.
- B. Auto-grading is too fast to be useful.
- C. The task requires recall, but the objective requires evaluation.
- D. Add more names and dates to the quiz.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A school is launching a new math curriculum. In the first month, teachers mostly ask how much prep time it takes and whether it will affect their evaluations. The school has an active PTA and a new gym floor. What should the leader focus on first?

- A. Show student achievement data from other schools.
- B. Ask the PTA to promote the curriculum.
- C. Address personal concerns with clear information about time, expectations, and evaluation.
- D. Tell teachers concerns are normal and move on.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A year into a new curriculum, teachers ask how to adjust it so more struggling students succeed. What stage of concern does this show?

- A. A personal concern.
- B. Resistance to the curriculum.
- C. A management concern.
- D. An impact concern.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A district plans to implement a new science curriculum with one full-day workshop in August led by a nationally known speaker. The district serves 18 schools. Which plan change will most improve implementation?

- A. Add ongoing coaching and regular team planning time through the year.
- B. Hire an even more famous speaker.
- C. Require all 18 schools to start on the same day with no support.
- D. Make the August workshop two days long.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A seventh-grade teacher ~~in a school with a new cafeteria~~ demonstrates how to write a thesis statement, then immediately assigns students to write three on their own. Most struggle. ~~Her class uses color-coded folders.~~ Which step did she skip?

Target word: missing phase **Decides:** Modeling went straight to independent work.

A	Camouflage	Organization is not the issue.
B	Correct	The “we do” phase is missing.
C	Inverted operation	Independent work comes last.
D	Adjacent category	More “I do” still leaves out guided practice.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Students are now writing thesis statements with a partner while the teacher circulates and prompts. Which step should come next?

Target word: next phase **Decides:** Collaborative practice precedes independent practice.

A	Adjacent category	Assessment of mastery before independent practice is premature.
B	Absolute language	Release happens when students are ready, not perfect.
C	Inverted operation	Moves backward in the release.
D	Correct	After collaborative work, students work alone.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A science teacher ~~in a school with a rooftop garden~~ plans a 5E lesson on density. She begins with a video of a floating egg, then gives a lecture defining density, then has students test objects in water. ~~The lesson lasts 55 minutes.~~ What is out of order?

Target word: sequence error **Decides:** Explanation comes before exploration.

A	Inverted operation	The engaging hook belongs first.
B	Camouflage	Length does not fix sequence.
C	Correct	In 5E, exploration builds experience before explanation.
D	Absolute language	Inquiry models delay formal explanation.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

After students explain density, the teacher asks them to predict whether a new object will float in salt water. Which 5E phase is this?

Target word: classify the phase **Decides:** Applying understanding to a new situation.

A	Correct	Extending the concept to a new context.
B	Adjacent category	Engage opens the lesson.
C	Confusion set	Explore comes before the explanation.
D	Inverted operation	Explain is where the concept is formalized.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A teacher in a district that just adopted a new bell schedule begins a lesson by asking students what they remember about fractions from last week before introducing adding unlike fractions. ~~The classroom has a large window facing the playground.~~ Which instructional event is this?

Target word: classify the event **Decides:** Asking about last week's learning.

A	Inverted operation	That comes at the end, not the start.
B	Correct	Activates what students already know.
C	Confusion set	Not a graded check of the new objective.
D	Adjacent category	Attention-getters hook interest, not prior knowledge.

6. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A lesson plan includes stating objectives, presenting content, and a final quiz, but no practice between them. Which event is missing?

Target word: reverse: missing event **Decides:** No practice with feedback.

A	Dropped element	Already included.
B	Correct	Students need practice and feedback before assessment.
C	Wrong stem number	Already in the plan.
D	Absolute language	Leaves out practice.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A fifth-grade team in a school with a large gym plans a unit on local water quality. Teachers will lecture for three weeks, then students will make a poster in the final two days. The team calls it project-based learning. ~~The school's mascot is a heron.~~ What would make it true PBL?

Target word: fix the PBL design **Decides:** The project is an add-on after instruction.

A	Inverted operation	Removes the project instead of fixing it.
B	Camouflage	Theming does not make it PBL.
C	Dropped element	Still an end-of-unit add-on.
D	Correct	In PBL the project drives the unit.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A teacher is an expert with video-editing software and ~~has 300 followers on a teaching social media account.~~ She has students make videos in chemistry, but the videos repeat textbook definitions and include errors about bonding. Which TPACK area needs growth?

Target word: weak knowledge area **Decides:** Tech skill is strong; content and pedagogy use are weak.

A	Correct	Tech skill alone does not produce good integration.
B	Absolute language	All three areas must work together.
C	Inverted operation	Her tech skill is already strong.
D	Camouflage	Followers are irrelevant.

9. Answer C Concept 6

The objective for a tenth-grade unit is “evaluate the reliability of historical sources.” A teacher in a district with a one-to-one laptop program assigns an online matching quiz of historians’ names to dates. The quiz auto-grades in seconds. What is the main design problem?

Target word: task-objective level mismatch **Decides:** Recall task for an evaluate objective.

A	Adjacent category	The medium is not the problem; the cognitive level is.
B	Camouflage	Speed does not decide alignment.
C	Correct	The digital task’s level is below the objective’s.
D	Dropped element	More recall still misses evaluation.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A school is launching a new math curriculum. In the first month, teachers mostly ask how much prep time it takes and whether it will affect their evaluations. The school has an active PTA and a new gym floor. What should the leader focus on first?

Target word: support matched to stage **Decides:** Teachers show personal (self) concerns.

A	Inverted operation	Impact data answers a later-stage concern.
B	Camouflage	Does not address teacher concerns.
C	Correct	Self-concerns must be addressed before task or impact concerns.
D	Dropped element	Acknowledges but does not address them.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A year into a new curriculum, teachers ask how to adjust it so more struggling students succeed. What stage of concern does this show?

Target word: classify the stage **Decides:** Focus on student results.

A	Inverted operation	Personal concerns center on the teacher.
B	Confusion set	Asking how to improve results is engagement, not resistance.
C	Adjacent category	Management concerns are about logistics and time.
D	Correct	They are focused on effects on students.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A district plans to implement a new science curriculum with one full-day workshop in August led by a nationally known speaker. The district serves 18 schools. Which plan change will most improve implementation?

Target word: effective implementation support **Decides:** Only a one-time training is planned.

A	Correct	Sustained, job-embedded support drives lasting change.
B	Camouflage	Speaker fame is not the issue.
C	Absolute language	Uniform start does not add support.
D	Dropped element	Still a one-time event.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Gradual release of responsibility	Move from teacher modeling (I do) to guided practice (we do) to collaborative and independent practice (you do).	Jumping from explanation straight to independent work.	A lesson where students struggle alone right after a demonstration.
2	The 5E inquiry sequence	Engage, Explore, Explain, Elaborate, Evaluate: students explore the phenomenon before formal explanation.	Explaining the concept before students explore it.	Where the teacher's explanation falls in an inquiry lesson.
3	Gagné's events of instruction	Instruction flows from gaining attention and stating objectives through recalling prior learning, presenting content, guiding, practicing with feedback, assessing, and supporting retention and transfer.	Treating presentation of content as the whole lesson.	Identifying which event a lesson step represents.
4	Authentic project-based learning	In true PBL the project is the unit: a driving question, sustained inquiry, student voice, and a public product.	Calling an end-of-unit craft or poster a project-based unit.	A project that comes after all the teaching is done.
5	TPACK	Effective tech integration sits where technology, pedagogy, and content knowledge overlap for a specific learning goal.	Assuming tech skill alone makes integration effective.	A teacher strong in one area but weak in another.
6	Digital tasks at the right cognitive level	Deep learning comes from digital tasks that require analysis, evaluation, or creation, matched to the objective's level.	Moving recall worksheets onto a device and calling it deeper learning.	A digital activity whose verb is lower than the objective's verb.
7	Stages of concern during change	Teachers adopting a curriculum move from self-concerns (what is it, how will it affect me) to task concerns (managing it) to impact concerns (student results); support should match their stage.	Pushing student-impact data on teachers still worried about how the change affects them.	Teacher questions about time, workload, or personal effects.
8	Sustained implementation support	Curriculum changes stick with ongoing, job-embedded support such as coaching and collaborative planning, not one-time workshops.	Relying on a single launch training.	An implementation plan with one kickoff day.

Course scope (public description): Designing Curriculum and Instruction II examines commonly used curriculum and instructional models and demonstrates how they can be used during the design process to achieve curricular and instructional goals. This course demonstrates how to design curriculum and instruction that leverages digital tools to facilitate deep, authentic learning and provides strategies for ensuring successful curriculum implementation. Designing Curriculum and Instruction I is a prerequisite for this course.